RANKPILOT: LEGAL DIRECTORY PORTAL

Setup Wizard

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Risk Level: Moderate

Pérez Correa González is not an elite banking submission yet, but it is credibly recognisable as a serious cross-border finance practice. The record already proves institutional lending capability, lead-counsel responsibility, and real New York-law/Mexican-law structuring. The immediate issue is not substance; it is presentation discipline — if the firm reframes the evidence properly, Band 4 is achievable and Band 3 becomes arguable.

Status: completed
Practice: Banking & Finance
Location:

THE UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

Strategic Audit Letter

To: Board of Directors at
From: RankPilot Consulting
Date: 20/5/2026

Strategic Audit Letter

To: The Board of Directors at Pérez Correa González
From: RankPilot Consulting
Date: 20 May 2026
Subject: Decision-ready strategic audit of your Banking & Finance submission

THE STATE OF PLAY

Your current positioning is **label='Consolidated'**: the evidence is strong enough for entry-level banking recognition and supports a credible push into Band 4 or Band 3, but it does not yet read as Elite. The submission shows multiple sizable transactions, recurring lender-side and borrower-side lead roles, and real cross-border structuring across New York and Mexican law. However, the portfolio is still concentrated in mid-market-to-upper-mid-market work, with no clear market-dominating franchise, no headline syndication platform, and only limited proof of repeat standalone flagship mandates at scale. For an unknown current trajectory, this is a consolidated entry candidate rather than a top-tier outlier.

That is the market reality: this is a real banking practice, not a narrative problem disguised as one. The file contains enough institutional work to be taken seriously, but not enough disciplined framing to be treated as obviously superior.

THE UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

Your weapon is unusually clear. The strongest evidence is **repeated lead-counsel responsibility on cross-border secured financings, including negotiating and structuring both the credit documents and the Mexican collateral packages**. Paired with **clear structural sophistication through New York-law / Mexican-law splits, bespoke security packages, trust/receivables mechanics, and multi-borrower or acquisition-finance contexts**, this is exactly the kind of transaction architecture that can move a firm from entry recognition into a credible Band 4 or Band 3 push.

This is not generic banking support work. It is demonstrable execution on financings where structure matters, enforcement matters, and cross-border mechanics matter.

THE REALITY CHECK

Here is the truth that needs to be heard plainly.

- **Crisp financing-product framing is inconsistent**
- **Cross-border mechanics are present but not always foregrounded**
- **Some matters drift into regulatory/compliance framing**
- **Market significance is under-communicated relative to the available evidence**
- **0 Structural Gaps (Fully optimized submission)**

The last point matters: there is no structural deficiency in the evidence set. The problem is that the submission is not yet talking like a banking platform. Chambers-style reviewers will not reward capable finance work if it is described in compliance language, impact prose, or generic institutional polish. They need to see the deal, the product, the side, the role, and the structure immediately.

THE PATH TO DOMINANCE

The only credible route to elevation is **STEP 1: Reframe matters into financing-product stories (Strategic Narrative)**.

Why this is the correct first move: the remaining window is 10 days, so the fastest path to an Entry-level Banking submission is not adding new work but fixing framing. The current evidence is strongest when it reads as actual lending work: New York-law credit facility, Mexican-law secured facility, syndicated loan, acquisition finance, and lender-side collateral packages. To break into Band 4 or Band 3, every matter must open with the product, the client side, and the firm's role. This directly addresses the current blind spot where matters drift into regulatory/compliance language or impact prose and therefore lose transactional credibility.

How to execute it: rewrite each shortlisted matter into a one-sentence lead paragraph in the form:

> *""[Firm] advised [client side/client] on a [facility type] for [borrower/client], with [lead structuring/negotiation role], under [governing law split if any].""*

Use this structure for Fernando Eraña, Jorge Labastida, Emilio Carrillo, and Eduardo Yrigoyen matters. Strip out generic language about compliance, reputation, sustainable growth, and culture of compliance unless it is directly tied to deal execution. For SMBC, Doopla, and other non-transactional items, either recast them for another table or exclude them from the Banking submission.

Timeline: must be completed by **22 May 2026**.

STEP 2: Prioritise institutional-ticket financing mandates

The submission should be built around matters that create scale credibility. The strongest evidence already available is:

- **USD 850 million Banobras/SMBC**
- **USD 250 million Sucro**
- **USD 246 million Truelink Capital**
- **USD 235 million BMO**
- **USD 170 million SMBC/BNEX**
- **USD 125 million BMO/Stemcor**
- **USD 50 million and USD 45 million SMBC financings**
- **USD 35 million IDB matter**

These are the matters that create baseline Chambers credibility. Smaller or weaker-fit items dilute the submission and make the department look more compliance-heavy than transactional.

How to execute it: build a final matter list that keeps only matters with clean financing-product framing, institutional counterparties, and a defensible Banking fit. Retain the strongest lender/borrower-side transactions: SMBC/Banobras, Sucro, Truelink Capital, BMO/AJC-Amerifoods, SMBC/BNEX, BMO/Stemcor, and the IDB superfoods financing. Move the SMBC regulatory program and Doopla compliance matter out of Banking. For each retained matter, ensure the value is stated in the first sentence and that the headline commercial purpose is explicit. Remove any matter where the financing product cannot be stated crisply in one line.

Timeline: must be completed by **23 May 2026**.

STEP 3: Clarify lead-counsel and client-side position

Your ranking case will strengthen materially if the Board makes responsibility impossible to miss. Chambers-style review is unforgiving on this point: if the role is blurred, the evidence weakens even when the underlying matter is strong.

The best evidence already shows PCG as lead counsel or spearheading work for **Fernando Eraña, Jorge Labastida, and Eduardo Yrigoyen** matters, and as lender-side counsel for **BMO, SMBC, and IDB**.

How to execute it: for each retained matter, state the client side in the first clause and repeat it once in the complexity paragraph: lender-side, borrower-side, or sponsor-side. Replace vague verbs like “assisted,” “supported,” or “routinely advised” with “spearheaded,” “led,” “structured,” “negotiated,” or “architected” only where the evidence supports it. Make Fernando Eraña the lead partner on Truelink Capital and DFC/Calvert, Jorge Labastida on SMBC regulatory-linked items only if retained elsewhere, and Eduardo Yrigoyen as supporting counsel where appropriate. Avoid over-claiming on matters that are actually ongoing compliance platforms rather than transactions.

Timeline: must be completed by **24 May 2026**.

STEP 4: Foreground cross-border and security mechanics

This is where the practice can stop looking competent and start looking distinctive. The best evidence in this department is not size alone; it is structure.

The real transactional strength lies in:

- New York-law / Mexican-law splits
- Mexican collateral packages
- trust mechanics
- receivables capture
- bespoke collateral
- multi-borrower or acquisition-finance structures

These are precisely the mechanics that support a Band 4 or Band 3 push because they show the firm can handle real cross-border execution, not just local lending.

How to execute it: for each key matter, add one sentence that isolates the structural feature: New York-law facility plus Mexican collateral, two-tier cross-border loan, syndicated multi-bank structure, acquisition finance with Mexican security, or receivables/trust mechanics. Use the DFC/Calvert matter to show trust and collateral sophistication; use Sucro, BMO/Stemcor, and the SMBC facilities to show governing-law splits and Mexican security enforcement; use Truelink to show acquisition finance; use the IDB matter to show multi-country structuring. Delete any paragraph that spends more space on industry background than on the financing architecture.

Timeline: must be completed by **25 May 2026**.

STEP 5: Concentrate proof into seven core mandates

The last step is pruning. An Entry candidate does not need a sprawling inventory; it needs a compact set of clear, believable, transaction-led mandates. Over-including weak-fit matters causes dilution.

How to execute it: create a final shortlist of approximately seven matters:

- SMBC/Banobras
- Sucro
- Truelink Capital
- BMO/AJC-Amerifoods
- SMBC/BNEX
- IDB superfoods
- one of the smaller but still clean lender-side SMBC facilities if needed for volume

Exclude Doopla entirely. Exclude the SMBC regulatory platform unless it is repackaged under Financial Services Regulatory rather than Banking. Ensure no matter repeats the same product description with only different party names; each retained matter should add a distinct financing pattern, such as acquisition finance, syndicated lending, lender-side secured lending, or cross-border collateralised lending.

Timeline: must be completed by **30 May 2026**.

BOARD DIRECTIVE

If you want the ranking outcome to move, do not seek more evidence. Seek **cleaner evidence architecture**. The department already has the right transactions; it now needs to speak in the language of a banking practice rather than a broad advisory platform.

If the Board approves the reframing programme immediately, the submission can credibly advance from **Consolidated** to **Band 4 territory**, with **Band 3** becoming a realistic ambition rather than a speculative one.

RankPilot Consulting

EVOLUTION PATH

STEP 1 [PENDING]

Reframe matters into financing-product stories

STEP 2 [PENDING]

Prioritize institutional-ticket financing mandates

STEP 3 [PENDING]

Clarify lead-counsel and client-side position

STEP 4 [PENDING]

Foreground cross-border and security mechanics

STEP 5 [PENDING]